Student Attrition Risk & Intervention Briefing

Application overview and user instructions | Team 115 • QUT Digital Business Solutions

Purpose. The application brings student attrition-risk patterns and an AI-assisted advisor briefing into one workflow. Business users can explore the available data, locate a de-identified student record, review the model's signal and consider supportive next steps. It does not decide whether a student needs intervention.

How the workflow fits together

1 Explore	2 Identify	3 Review	4 Consider
Risk patterns	De-identified ID	Student snapshot	Advisor-led action

The two user-facing parts

Part	What it provides
Risk Overview dashboard	Aggregate risk patterns, course analysis, demographic breakdown, student list and available filters. Use it to explore the data and locate a de-identified Student ID.
Student Advisor Briefing page	Risk classification and relative score, approved snapshot fields, structured AI-assisted briefing, save confirmation and PDF download.

Dashboard pages

Page	Use it to...
Overview	Review student counts and aggregate risk-level/score distributions.
Course Analysis	Compare aggregate patterns by course level and field of education.
Demographic Breakdown	Explore aggregate patterns across available demographic categories.
Student List	Locate a de-identified Student ID and inspect student-level risk information.
Filters	Narrow views by risk level, course level, field of education, origin, age band and commencing/continuing status.

Find and retrieve a student

- In Student List, locate the record and copy its de-identified Student ID exactly. Do not use a name or other identifying information.
- Open the Student Advisor Briefing page, enter the ID and select Retrieve. Review the classification, relative score, threshold, scoring timestamp where available, and approved snapshot information.
- If no record is found, check the ID for missing characters or spaces and try again.

Generate and review the briefing

- Briefing generation is available only for a record currently classified At Risk. Select Generate Advisor Briefing and wait for the result.
- Read the four sections: Risk Summary, Relevant Student Context, Recommended Advisor Actions and Suggested Next Steps.
- Compare important statements with the displayed record. Treat recommended actions as options to consider, not instructions or decisions made by the AI.
- If a validated briefing is already saved, the application may return that briefing instead of generating another. Select Regenerate when a fresh briefing is needed.
- A successful regeneration replaces the previous saved briefing as the latest available version. Select Download Briefing to export the displayed briefing as a PDF.

Save status: A successful save is confirmed on screen. If the application reports that a briefing could not be stored, do not assume the new briefing was saved.

Common issues

Issue	What to do
No prediction found	Re-copy the de-identified ID and check for missing characters or spaces.
Briefing could not be produced	Try again later. If the issue persists, record the message and contact the designated project/workspace support contact.
Briefing could not be stored	Do not treat it as saved. Retry later or contact support; look for an explicit save confirmation.
Student is Not At Risk	Briefing generation is unavailable for that record. Do not try to bypass this restriction.
Filter does not update a view	Clear and reapply the filter. If the issue persists, note the dashboard page and selected filter and report it.

Interpret risk carefully

- A signal, not certainty. The classification does not establish that attrition will or will not occur.
- Relative score, not calibrated probability. The displayed percentage is a model-generated relative risk score, not a calibrated probability that a student will leave university.
- Snapshot, not a trend. The data is cross-sectional; it does not show individual change over time, historical decline or a cause for the score.
- No individual causal explanation. The application does not provide per-student feature-contribution evidence. Attributes are context only; global feature importance is not proof of why an individual received a score.

Proof-of-concept boundary. This project uses synthetic, de-identified student data. It demonstrates a risk-review and briefing workflow; it is not a production student-support system and must not be used to make decisions about real students.

Use AI output responsibly

- Treat the briefing as decision support, not a verified account of the student's circumstances. The advisor remains responsible for professional judgement and action.
- Do not infer personal circumstances or support needs. Do not use demographic information to explain a prediction or make stereotyped or deficit-based statements.
- Do not assume named services, dates, deadlines or follow-up timeframes that were not supplied by the context or an approved process.
- Verify important statements against the record. If output is unsupported, incorrect, insensitive or incomplete, do not rely on that statement; report the issue through the agreed support channel.

Privacy and information handling

- Use only the de-identified Student ID. Do not enter student names or other identifying information into the workflow.
- Treat downloaded PDF briefings as potentially sensitive project records. Store and share them only through approved organisational channels.
- Apply relevant QUT processes before considering action. The advisor decides whether support or intervention is appropriate.

Before acting: quick review

Check	Question to ask
Correct record	Am I reviewing the intended de-identified student record?
Evidence	Are important statements supported by the displayed snapshot or another approved source?
Interpretation	Have I separated the model's score from contextual facts and AI suggestions?
Next steps	Are proposed actions supportive, appropriate and consistent with approved processes?

Support and handover

For access problems, persistent application errors or questions about displayed data, contact the nominated QUT Digital Business Solutions/project support contact. Include the page, action attempted and error message—never student-identifying information.

Before distribution: Confirm the published dashboard URL, nominated support contact and current workspace behaviour. Technical documentation should separately cover architecture, setup/deployment and maintenance.